

The `colophon` Package, v1.1

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Abstract

The *colophon* is fascinating to anyone even slightly interested in typography and document design; and yet incredibly, the best document design system ever produced *has no facilities for producing colophons*. Hence, the `colophon` package.

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1 Introduction

Colophons date back to ancient times, where scribes would simply write in where they'd gotten the text that they'd copied, and what they'd changed in it. One might see a colophon that read, *A M. Tullio Cicerone, e texto G. Juliani Cæsaris, cum tribus libris novis* ("By Marcus Tullius Cicero, from a text of Gaius Julius Caesar, with three new books." Though why Cicero is adding to a book of Julius Caesar, and using a "j" long before it became a letter, is a mystery.)

When printing was invented, publishers would add a colophon, often at the end (rather than at the beginning, where it typically sits now), noting their identities and addresses. Over time, particularly with small publishers, colophons got bigger, and contained information about design, font types, and the like. Too often they're completely omitted now, but I think it's still worth putting them in. I know that I *love* to see them in the books I read, at least.